

Intonation

In linguistics, Intonation is the variation in pitch used to indicate the speaker's attitudes and emotions. In other words it is the rise and fall in the voice while speaking.

There are two basic intonation patterns, namely

Rising Tune

Falling Tune

Intonation patterns are indicated in writing using arrows.

Falling tune



Rising tune



USES OF THE RISING TUNE

A) Yes or No questions that require yes or no answer. Example

- 1) Is English your best subject?
- 2) Are you going to eat that?

B) Incomplete Statement ,

- 1) As soon as the rain stops
- 2) Although I had never met the senator,
- 3) Since the cost of books has risen,.

C,) Simple polite requests.

Examples:

- 1) Could you pass the sugar, please?
- 2) A minute of your time please?
- 3) Could you me your pen ?



D) Surprise questions

Examples:



1) She eats cockroaches?

2) She is the younger sister?

E) Confirmation questions

1) You are from FCT, right?

2) We meet at six, right?

F) Expressing uncertainty / doubts .

Examples:

1) You think so?

2) He did what?

G) Listing items

1) We bought apples, oranges and bananas.

2) I invited Mary, John and Paul.

